I. Introduction to E-Marketing

E-Marketing (Online Marketing):

Promoting and selling products, services and brands using the Internet and digital channels - websites, search engines, social media, email, mobile apps - and measuring the results.

Meaning

- Also called internet marketing, digital marketing, web marketing.
- Uses the 4 Ps (product, price, place, promotion) in a digital form.
- Two-way communication: customers can reply, share, review.
- Results are measurable in real time (clicks, views, sales).

Online Marketing Mix (E-Marketing 4 Ps -> 4 Cs)

Traditional P	Online view
Product	Customisable, digital products, bundles
Price	Dynamic pricing, discounts, price comparison
Place	Website, app, marketplace - available everywhere
Promotion	SEO, ads, social media, email, influencers

Advantages of Online Marketing

- **Global reach:** from local to worldwide.
- **Low cost:** cheaper than TV or print; small budgets possible.
- **Targeting:** by age, location, interest and behaviour.
- **Measurable:** analytics show clicks, conversions and ROI.
- **Interactive & personal:** engage and build relations with customers.
- **24 x 7 availability** and instant updates.
- **Quick feedback** and A/B testing of offers.
- **Level playing field:** small firms compete with large ones.

Limitations

- Heavy competition and ad fatigue; ad blockers.
- Privacy and spam complaints; click fraud.
- Needs technical skill and constant updating.
- Not reachable to people without internet.

2. Internet Advertisement

Internet Advertising:

Paid promotional messages delivered to users through websites, search engines, apps, email and social media in order to attract attention and create sales.

Features

- Interactive - users can click, watch, buy at once.
- Targeted and personalised; cost per click / view.
- Real-time measurement; flexible budget and timing.

Advantages

- Lower cost and wider reach than traditional media.
- Immediate results; campaigns can be paused or changed anytime.

Disadvantages

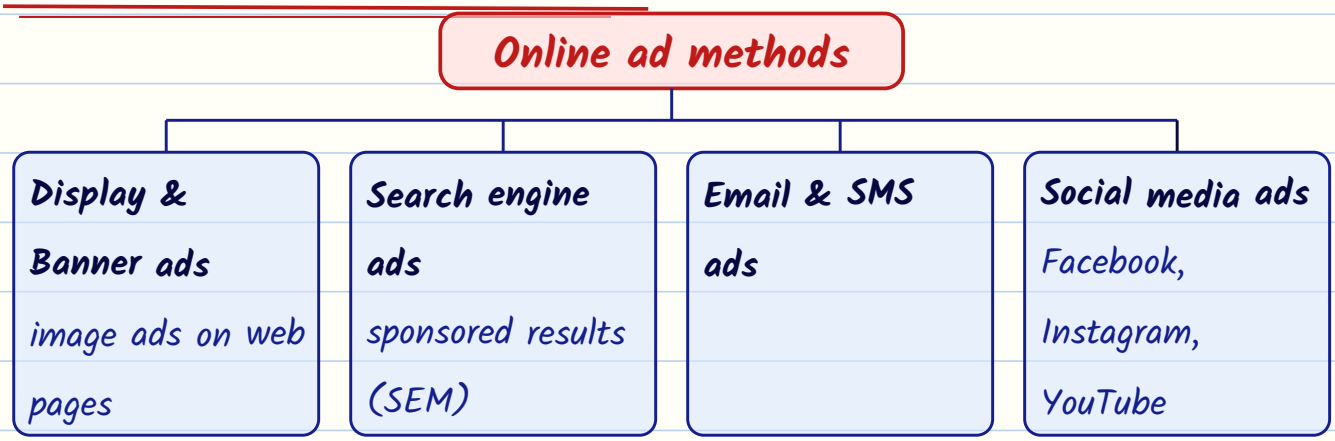
- Ad blockers; users ignore banners (banner blindness).
- Privacy concerns about tracking; click fraud.

Pricing Models of Internet Ads

Model	Meaning
CPM (Cost per Mille)	Pay for every 1000 impressions (views)
CPC / PPC (Pay per Click)	Pay each time a user clicks the ad
CPA / CPL (per Action / Lead)	Pay only when a sale, signup or lead happens

CPV (per View)	Pay for video views (YouTube)
Flat fee / sponsorship	Fixed price for a time period or position

3. Advertisement Methods



3.1 Banner / Display Ads

- Graphic or animated ads on web pages; clicking leads to the advertiser site.
- Sizes: leaderboard, skyscraper, rectangle. Retargeting shows ads again to past visitors.

3.2 Search Engine Marketing (SEM)

- **SEO (Search Engine Optimisation):** improve site content, keywords, speed and links to rank higher in FREE (organic) results.
- **PPC (Google Ads):** paid sponsored results on top of search page; pay per click.

3.3 Email Advertising

- Promotional mails and newsletters to subscribers; high return on investment.
- Needs permission (opt-in) to avoid spam.

3.4 Social Media Ads

- Paid posts and videos on Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn, X; very precise targeting.

3.5 Pop-up, Interstitial and Video Ads

- Pop-up: new small window; interstitial: full screen between pages; video: pre-roll / mid-roll on YouTube.

3.6 Other Methods

- **Affiliate marketing:** partners promote your product and earn commission per sale.
- **Influencer marketing:** popular personalities endorse the brand.
- **Native / sponsored content:** ad that looks like normal article or post.
- **Classified ads:** OLX, Quikr, Justdial listings.
- **Mobile advertising:** in-app ads, SMS, push notifications.
- **Viral marketing:** message spreads on its own through sharing.
- **Content & blogs, webinars, podcasts, QR codes.**

4. Conducting Online Market Research

Online Market Research:

Collecting, analysing and interpreting information about customers, competitors and the market using the Internet, to support marketing decisions.

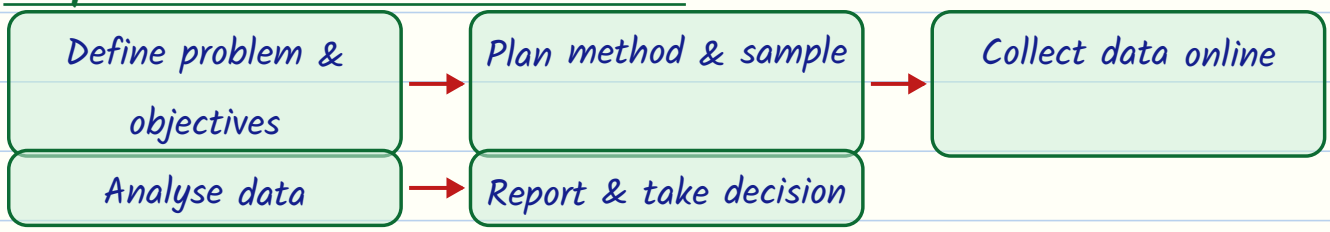
Types of Data

- **Primary data:** gathered first-hand for the purpose.
- **Secondary data:** already published (reports, websites, government data).

Methods of Online Research

- **Online surveys / questionnaires:** Google Forms, SurveyMonkey, email polls.
- **Focus groups and interviews:** by video call or chat rooms.
- **Web analytics:** page views, bounce rate, time spent, sources of traffic (Google Analytics).
- **Social listening / monitoring:** track brand mentions, trends, sentiment.
- **Customer reviews and feedback forms.**
- **Experiments:** A/B testing of pages and ads.
- **Secondary research:** search engines, online databases, competitor sites, e-journals, government portals (data.gov.in).
- **Cookies and clickstream data** - tracking user behaviour.

Steps in Online Market Research



Advantages

- Fast, cheaper and wider reach than field research.
- Easy data entry and automatic analysis; real-time results.
- Respondents answer at convenient time; fewer interviewer errors.

Limitations

- Sample bias - only internet users take part; low response rates.
- Fake or careless responses; privacy and consent issues.
- Cannot observe body language.

5. E-Marketing Planning

An e-marketing plan sets goals for online activities, defines the target audience, selects channels and budget, and sets measures of success.



- **Objectives:** brand awareness, leads, sales, retention - make them SMART (specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, time-bound).
- **Target market:** segmentation by demographics, interests, behaviour; build customer personas.
- **Positioning:** how the brand is different from competitors.
- **Tactics:** SEO, ads, content, email, social, mobile.
- **Budget, schedule and responsibility.**
- **Control:** KPIs - traffic, conversion rate, cost per acquisition, ROI, customer lifetime value.

5.1 Online Branding

Online Branding:

Building a recognisable identity, reputation and trust for a business on the Internet - name, logo, domain, website design, tone of content and customer experience.

- Choose a short memorable domain name and logo; consistent colours and message everywhere.
- Quality content, fast and mobile-friendly website, good user experience.

- Customer reviews, testimonials and quick support build trust.
- Brand presence on social media, marketplaces and search results.
- Monitor and manage online reputation (ORM).

5.2 Social Media Marketing (SMM)

SMM:

Using social platforms - Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn, X, WhatsApp - to create awareness, interact with customers and drive traffic and sales.

- Activities: regular posts, reels / videos, stories, contests, live sessions, groups and communities, paid ads, influencer tie-ups, customer service replies.
- Benefits: low cost, viral reach, direct engagement, precise targeting, instant feedback.
- Risks: negative comments, fake news, time and constant effort, platform algorithm changes.
- Measures: likes, shares, comments, reach, followers, click-through rate (CTR).

5.3 Email Marketing

Email Marketing:

Sending commercial messages - newsletters, offers, order updates, reminders - to a list of people who have agreed to receive them.

- Types: welcome mail, promotional, newsletter, abandoned-cart reminder, transactional, re-engagement.
- **Best practices:** permission-based list, catchy subject line, personalisation (name, interest), clear call-to-action (CTA), mobile-friendly design, test and send at the right time, easy unsubscribe.

- Measures: open rate, click-through rate, bounce rate, conversion rate, unsubscribes.
- Advantages: very cheap, high ROI, direct, easy to automate.
- Problems: spam filters, low open rates, privacy law (consent).

Comparison of the Three Channels

Basis	Online Branding	Social Media	Email
Aim	Identity and trust	Engagement and reach	Direct sales and retention
Cost	Medium	Low - medium	Very low
Reach	Wide	Very wide	Existing list
Key tool	Website, logo, ORM	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube	Mailing list, newsletters

6. E-Business Strategies

E-Business Strategy:

A long-term plan that explains how a firm will use digital technology and the Internet to create value, gain competitive advantage and reach its business goals.

6.1 Digital Advertising

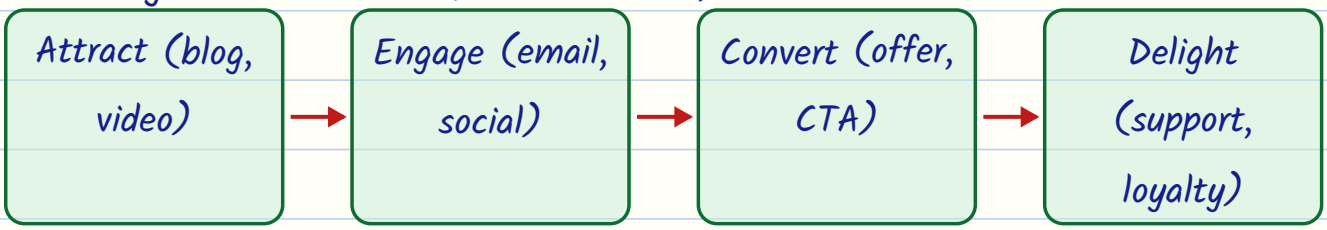
- Paid media: search ads, display, video, social ads, mobile and programmatic (automated bidding in real time).
- Needs clear target, creative message, landing page and tracking of conversions.
- Retargeting and remarketing increase sales from interested visitors.

6.2 Content Marketing

Content Marketing:

Creating and sharing valuable, relevant and consistent content - blogs, videos, podcasts, infographics, e-books, webinars - to attract and keep a clearly defined audience and finally drive profitable action.

- Content builds trust, helps SEO, educates customers and nurtures leads.
- Steps: know audience → plan content calendar → create → distribute (social, email, search) → measure and improve.
- Types: educational (how-to), entertaining, inspirational, user-generated (UGC), case studies, FAQs.



6.3 Analytics

Web / Digital Analytics:

Collecting, measuring and analysing data about website visitors and campaigns to understand behaviour and improve results.

- Tools: Google Analytics, Search Console, social insights, heat maps, CRM reports.
- **Metrics:** visitors / sessions, page views, bounce rate, average time on site, traffic source, click-through rate, conversion rate, cart abandonment, cost per acquisition, ROI, customer lifetime value.
- Uses: find best channel, improve website, personalise offers, decide budget, predict demand (big data and AI).

Other E-Business Strategies

- Cost leadership through automation; differentiation by service and customisation.
- Mass personalisation and recommendation engines.
- Strategic alliances, affiliate and partner programmes.
- Omni-channel presence: website + app + store + marketplace.
- Disintermediation and re-intermediation; first-mover advantage; network effects.

7. E-Customer Relationship Management (eCRM)

eCRM:

Use of the Internet and electronic tools to attract, understand, serve and retain customers by managing all interactions through web, email, chat, social media and mobile apps.

Objectives

- Acquire new customers, retain existing ones, raise customer lifetime value.
- Give personalised, quick and consistent service on every channel.

Components of eCRM

- **Operational:** automation of sales, marketing and service (help desk, chatbot, order tracking).
- **Analytical:** data warehouse, data mining to find buying patterns and segments.
- **Collaborative:** sharing customer information between departments and partners through email, portals, social media.



Features / Tools

- Customer database and profile; self-service portal and FAQs.
- Live chat, chatbots, email response management, call-centre integration.
- Loyalty programmes, personalised recommendations, targeted email.
- Feedback and complaint handling; social CRM.
- Software: Salesforce, Zoho CRM, HubSpot, Microsoft Dynamics.

Advantages

- Better customer satisfaction and loyalty; repeat sales.
- Lower service cost through self-service and automation.
- Better targeting and 360-degree view of customer.
- Quick problem solving; improved brand image.

Challenges

- High cost of set-up and integration; data quality.
- Privacy and data protection duties.
- Staff training and change in culture.
- Too much automation may lose the human touch.

CRM vs eCRM

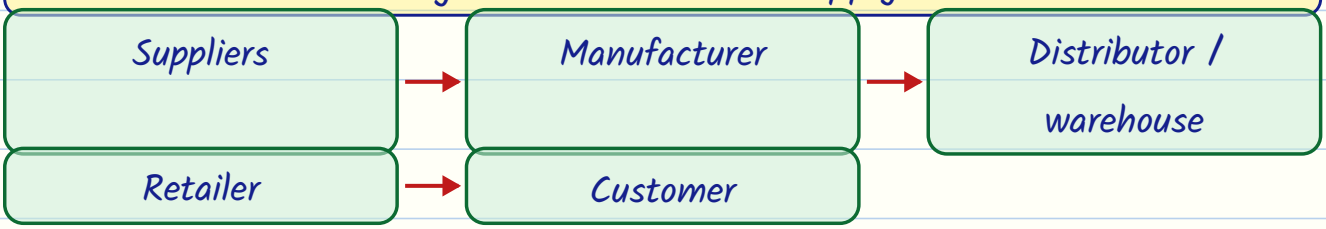
Basis	Traditional CRM	eCRM
Channel	Phone, in person, mail	Web, email, chat, social, app
Time	Business hours	24 x 7
Data	Limited and scattered	Integrated and real-time

Cost	Higher	Lower per contact
Interaction	One-way / slow	Interactive and instant

8. E-Supply Chain Management (e-SCM)

Supply Chain:

The network of suppliers, manufacturers, warehouses, distributors, retailers and customers that move a product from raw material to final consumer. e-SCM:: Use of the Internet and information technology to plan, coordinate and control the flow of materials, information and money across the whole supply chain.



- Three flows: **product flow** (forward goods and returns), **information flow** (orders, stock, tracking) and **finance flow** (payments, credit).

Components / Activities

- E-procurement: online buying, tenders and supplier portals.
- E-inventory and warehouse management (barcode, RFID).
- Demand forecasting and production planning.
- E-logistics: transport tracking (GPS), route planning, last-mile delivery.
- Order management and e-payment; returns management.

Technologies Used

- ERP, EDI (electronic data interchange), extranet, cloud platforms.
- RFID, barcode, GPS / IoT sensors, blockchain for traceability.

- Analytics, AI forecasting, automation and robots.

Advantages of e-SCM

- Lower inventory, purchase and logistics cost.
- Faster delivery and order cycle; fewer errors and stock-outs.
- Real-time visibility; better supplier and partner coordination.
- Reduced bullwhip effect (demand distortion up the chain).
- Higher customer satisfaction.

Challenges

- High IT investment; integration of partners' systems.
- Security and trust in sharing data.
- Disruptions (pandemics, wars, port delays) and dependency on technology.

eCRM vs e-SCM

Basis	eCRM	e-SCM
Focus	Customer side (front end)	Supplier and logistics side (back end)
Aim	Satisfy and retain customers	Efficient flow of goods and information
Parties	Customers	Suppliers, producers, distributors
Examples	Zoho CRM, Salesforce	SAP, Oracle SCM, EDI, GPS tracking

9. Quick Revision - Unit V

- E-marketing = promoting products through digital channels; measurable, low cost, targeted.
- Ad methods: banner, search (SEO / PPC), email, social, video,

affiliate, influencer. Pricing: CPM, CPC, CPA.

- Online market research: surveys, analytics, social listening, secondary data.
- E-marketing plan: SWOT, SMART objectives, target, mix, budget, KPIs.
- Branding builds trust; SMM engages; email is cheap and direct.
- Strategies: digital ads, content marketing, analytics. eCRM manages customers; e-SCM manages supply flows.

Likely Exam Questions

- Define online marketing and explain its advantages.
- Explain internet advertisement methods.
- How is online market research conducted?
- Explain online branding, social media marketing and email marketing.
- Describe digital advertising, content marketing and analytics strategies.
- Explain eCRM and e-SCM with features, advantages and challenges.